

Pricing: Sell Events, Not Subscriptions

One-time Event Passes for consumers. One Pro subscription for professionals.

July 3, 2026 · Internal

The Decision

We replace the three consumer subscription tiers with one-time Event Passes priced by guest count, and we consolidate Signature and Elite into a single Pro subscription for planners and venues. There is no free tier and no free trial. The app is a paid product: you buy access to plan your event, the same way you buy anything else for your wedding.

The model: Starter Pass \$9.99 (50 guests) · Standard Pass \$19.99 (150 guests) · Premium Pass \$39.99 (500 guests, collaboration) — one-time, per event. Pro subscription \$49/mo or \$490/yr for professionals. No free tier.

Why the Current Model Loses Money and Goodwill

Our customer base splits cleanly in two: couples planning a single event, and professionals who plan events for a living. The current pricing sells both of them the same thing — a subscription — and it is wrong for the larger segment.

- **Seating work happens in the last 1–3 months before an event**, after RSVPs arrive. A Core subscriber pays \$4–12 in total, then cancels the day after the wedding. That is not recurring revenue; it is a one-time purchase collected in installments, priced at a fraction of its value.
- **Churn at event date is 100% by design.** No retention tactic fixes a customer whose need has ended. Every dollar spent chasing consumer renewals is wasted.
- **Subscriptions for one-time events generate 1-star reviews.** “Forced me to subscribe for one party” and forgotten-renewal refund demands are the defining complaint pattern for event apps. This is reputation damage we are choosing in advance.
- **The market already prices per event.** Established table planners sell one-time licenses. Couples budget per-item for a wedding — venue, cake, photographer. A seating chart is a line item, not a service contract.

The subscription is the right shape for exactly one buyer: the professional who runs events continuously. So that is the only buyer we sell it to.

The Model

Event Passes — one-time purchase, per event

Pass	Price (one-time)	Guest cap	Includes
Starter	\$9.99	50	Floor plan editor, drag & drop seating, export & print
Standard	\$19.99	150	Starter + AI guest import
Premium	\$39.99	500	Standard + real-time collaboration (2 collaborators)

- **One pass = one event**, defined as one gathering: a ceremony and reception on the same day are one event. Access runs through **event date + 90 days** for exports and records.
- **Guest lists grow — that is our expansion revenue.** When a list crosses the cap, the customer pays the difference to upgrade tiers in place. This happens at the moment of highest willingness to pay.
- **Refunds:** unused passes are refundable, no questions asked. It costs almost nothing and eliminates purchase anxiety on a \$10–40 decision.

Pro — one subscription, for professionals

Plan	Price	Limits	Includes
Pro	\$49/mo or \$490/yr	100 events · 1,000 guests/event	Everything, 5 collaborators per event, priority support

Signature and Elite collapse into this single plan. Two pro tiers meant two sales pitches, two support matrices, and a \$24 tier that undercut our own \$49 tier. Pro pays for itself at thirteen Premium Passes a year — any working planner clears that bar, and anyone who doesn't is better served by passes. The positioning is one sentence: **planning an event, buy a pass; planning events for a living, go Pro.**

The funnel without a free tier

The app opens into a fully interactive **showcase event** — a pre-built wedding the user can rearrange, re-seat, and explore for as long as they like. Sixty seconds in the editor sells the product better than any screenshot. Creating *your* event is the purchase moment. This gives prospects a genuine hands-on experience while keeping a hard rule: **nobody plans a real event without paying.** No trial clock to game, no free tier to squat on, no anonymous usage to support.

The Numbers

Customer scenario	Today (subscription)	Proposed (pass)
120-guest wedding, seating built over final 2 months	Essentials $\$12 \times 2 \text{ mo} = \24 , then cancels	Standard \$19.99 ; upgrade to Premium when the list grows = \$39.99

Customer scenario	Today (subscription)	Proposed (pass)
60-guest rehearsal dinner, 1 month of use	Core \$4 × 1 mo = \$4	Standard \$19.99 — 5× the revenue
300-guest wedding, planned with a partner	Signature \$24 × 2 mo = \$48	Premium \$39.99 , collected without a cancellation flow or a resentful review
Venue, 30 events/year	Elite \$490/yr	Pro \$490/yr — unchanged

Across the consumer scenarios, revenue per event goes up in two cases and trades slightly down in one — in exchange for zero cancellation churn, zero refund disputes, and an App Store rating that isn't carrying subscription-trap reviews. The pro segment is untouched. We give up nothing we should want to keep: the only revenue the old model wins is from customers who forgot to cancel, and building a business on forgotten subscriptions is how you earn the reviews that kill an app.

Objections, Answered

- **“We lose recurring revenue.”** We never had it. Consumer “recurring” revenue with 100% event-date churn is one-time revenue wearing a costume. The genuinely recurring segment — professionals — keeps a subscription, and one-time pass revenue is cleaner to forecast than churn-adjusted MRR from single-event subscribers.
- **“No trial will hurt conversion.”** The showcase event is a better trial than a trial: it demonstrates the full product with no clock, and the purchase gate sits exactly where motivation peaks — the moment the customer wants to start their own event. Trials optimize for products whose value takes weeks to feel; ours lands in one minute of dragging tables.
- **“What about the host who plans three events a year?”** They buy three passes — \$60–120 of clean revenue — and when that stops feeling right, Pro is waiting. That is an upsell path, not a gap.
- **“Apple's cut?”** 15% under the Small Business Program at our scale. The same passes sell on the web through Stripe at ~3%, and a one-time web checkout converts far better than asking someone to manage a subscription — per-event pricing strengthens the web channel.

Execution

The switch is cheapest right now, before launch locks the subscription model in. The pieces we've already built carry over: Supabase entitlements, StoreKit 2 plumbing, and the paywall UI all remain — the products change from auto-renewable subscriptions to consumable purchases recorded against the event, with tier, guest cap, and expiry on the event record. Pro stays an auto-renewable subscription exactly as built. The web pricing page and App Store products ship together so the two channels never disagree.

- 1. Sign off on this model.

- 2. Rebuild App Store products: three consumables + one Pro subscription; update Supabase entitlements to per-event passes with upgrade-in-place.
- 3. Build the showcase event and move the purchase gate to event creation.
- 4. Update the web pricing page and Stripe products to match, then launch both channels together.

A Seat Awaits — internal pricing proposal, July 2026.